

90-DAY SOFTWARE TESTING CAREER ROADMAP

Requirements Traceability Matrix (RTM)

Map requirements to tests to defects so you can prove coverage and assess impact.

Introduction

An RTM links each requirement to the test cases that cover it and the defects raised against it. It answers two crucial questions: what is not covered, and if this requirement changes, what must we re-test?

Instructions

- List each requirement / acceptance criterion.
- Map the test case IDs that verify it.
- Record the latest result and any linked defects.
- Scan for requirements with no tests — those are coverage gaps.

Real QA Example

Req ID	Requirement	Test Cases	Result	Defects
REQ-1	User can log in with valid credentials	TC-LOGIN-001	Pass	-
REQ-2	Login blocked after 3 failed attempts	TC-LOGIN-005, 006	Fail	BUG-22
REQ-3	Password reset link expires in 60 min	(none)	-	- (gap!)

Blank Reusable Template

Req ID	Requirement	Test Cases	Result	Defects
			Pass/Fail	

Best Practice Tips

- Use it as a live coverage tool, not end-of-project paperwork.

- A requirement with no linked test is a red flag — address it.
- When a requirement changes, the RTM tells you exactly what to re-run.

Common Mistakes

- Filling it in once and never updating it.
- Linking tests to requirements but never to the defects found.
- Treating it as bureaucracy rather than a coverage/impact tool.

INSIDE STLC PRO TIP

An RTM is a brilliant interview talking point — it shows you think about coverage and change impact, not just running tests.